

Assignment 11: Implementing a Persistence Repository Layer

**NOTE: Please Create backlog/issues for all these activities you are doing **

Objective:

Design and implement a **repository layer** to persist your domain model objects. The implementation should:

1. **Abstract storage details** behind an interface (allowing easy swapping of storage backends).
 2. Support **CRUD operations** (Create, Read, Update, Delete) for domain entities.
 3. Use **Dependency Injection (DI)** or **Factory Pattern** to switch between storage implementations.
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Scenario

Your system now has well-defined domain classes (from Assignment 10). To make the application **persistent**, you must:

- Build a **repository layer** to store/retrieve objects.
 - Start with an **in-memory HashMap** for simplicity, but design it to be **easily replaceable** with:
 - Filesystem storage (JSON/XML files)
 - SQL/NoSQL databases (MySQL, MongoDB)
 - External REST APIs
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Tasks

1. Repository Interface Design (30 Marks)

Task:

- Define a **generic repository interface** with standard CRUD operations:

```
public interface Repository<T, ID> {  
    void save(T entity);           // Create/Update  
    Optional<T> findById(ID id);  // Read  
    List<T> findAll();            // Read All  
    void delete(ID id);           // Delete  
}
```

- Create **entity-specific interfaces** (e.g., `BookRepository` extends `Repository<Book, String>`).

Deliverables:

- A `/repositories` **directory** with interface definitions.
 - **Justification** in the README (e.g., `"Used generics to avoid duplication across entity repositories"`).
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2. In-Memory Implementation (30 Marks)

Task:

- Implement the repository using an **in-memory** `HashMap` / `Dictionary` .
- Example (Python):

```
class InMemoryBookRepository(BookRepository):
    def __init__(self):
        self._storage = {} # HashMap storage

    def save(self, book: Book) -> None:
        self._storage[book.id] = book

    def find_by_id(self, id: str) -> Optional[Book]:
        return self._storage.get(id)
```

Deliverables:

- A `/repositories/inmemory` **directory** with `HashMap`-based implementations.
 - **Test cases** verifying CRUD operations work correctly.
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3. Storage-Abstraction Mechanism (20 Marks)

Task:

- Ensure the **repository layer is decoupled** from storage specifics.
- Use one of these patterns:
 - **Dependency Injection (DI)**: Inject the repository implementation into services.
 - **Factory Pattern**: A `RepositoryFactory` returns the desired storage backend.

Example (Factory in Java):

```

public class RepositoryFactory {
    public static BookRepository getBookRepository(String storageType) {
        switch (storageType) {
            case "MEMORY": return new InMemoryBookRepository();
            case "DATABASE": return new DatabaseBookRepository(); // Future
implementation
            default: throw new IllegalArgumentException("Invalid storage
type");
        }
    }
}

```

Deliverables:

- A `/factories` or `/di` **directory** with your abstraction mechanism.
- **README update** explaining your choice (DI vs. Factory).

4. Future-Proofing (20 Marks)

Task:

- Design your system to **easily add new storage backends** later.
- Example: A `FileSystemBookRepository` could serialize objects to JSON:

```

class FileSystemBookRepository(BookRepository):
    def __init__(self, file_path: str):
        self._file_path = file_path

    def save(self, book: Book) -> None:
        books = self._load_all()
        books[book.id] = book
        with open(self._file_path, 'w') as f:
            json.dump(books, f)

```

Deliverables:

- A **stub implementation** (no full code needed) for one future storage option (e.g., `DatabaseBookRepository`).
- **Updated class diagram** showing repository interfaces and implementations.

Deliverables

1. Repository Interfaces:

- Generic and entity-specific interfaces (/repositories).

2. In-Memory Implementation:

- HashMap-based repositories (/repositories/inmemory).

3. Abstraction Mechanism:

- DI or Factory setup (/factories or /di).

4. Future-Proofing Docs:

- Stub for another storage backend.
- Updated class diagram.

5. Tests:

- Unit tests for in-memory repositories (/tests).
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Submission Guidelines

- **IMPORTANT** : Please check your URL that you submit to BB. Don't do it mindlessly
 - **Format**: Push to your existing GitHub repository and post a VALID LINK to Blackboard.
 - **Grading**:
 - **30%**: Repository interface design (generics, CRUD completeness).
 - **30%**: Working in-memory implementation.
 - **20%**: Proper abstraction (DI/Factory) for storage swapping.
 - **20%**: Future-proofing and documentation.
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Why This Matters

- **Separation of Concerns**: Business logic stays cleanly separated from storage details.
- **Scalability**: Switching to a real database later becomes trivial.
- **Testability**: In-memory repos enable fast unit tests without external dependencies.

Need Help?

- **Repository Pattern**: [Microsoft Docs](#)
 - **Dependency Injection**: [Martin Fowler's Article](#)
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